

CM0246 Discrete Structures

Cardinality

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Cardinality

Definition

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Injunction, surjection or bijection?

Draw figures in the whiteboard.

Cardinality

Example

(Proofs on the whiteboard)

- $|\mathbb{Z}^+| = |\mathbb{N}|$.

Cardinality

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- $|\mathbb{Z}^+| = |\mathbb{N}|$.
- $|\mathbb{N}| = |\text{Even}|$, where $\text{Even} = \{ 2n \mid n \in \mathbb{N} \}$.

Cardinality

Example

(Proofs on the whiteboard)

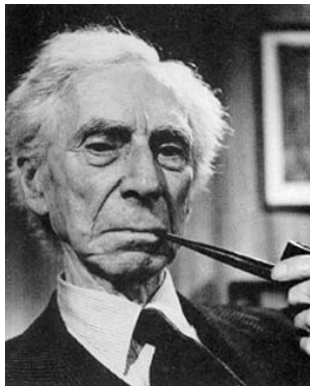
- $|\mathbb{Z}^+| = |\mathbb{N}|$.
- $|\mathbb{N}| = |\text{Even}|$, where $\text{Even} = \{ 2n \mid n \in \mathbb{N} \}$.
- $|\mathbb{N}| = |M_k|$, where M_k is the set of the non-negative multiples of $k \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, i.e. $M_k = \{ nk \mid n \in \mathbb{N} \}$.

Cardinality

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- $|[0, 1]| = |[a, b]|$, where $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$ and $a < b$.



(1872 – 1970)[†]

‘The possibility that whole and part may have the same number of terms is, it must be confessed, shocking to common-sense.’ (Russell 1903, p. 358)

[†]Image from the MacTutor History of Mathematics Archive.

Cardinality

Example (Lipschutz ([1964] 1998), Solved problem 6.2, p. 153)

Show that $|[0, 1]| = |(0, 1)|$.

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Solution

Note that

$$\begin{aligned}[0, 1] &= \{0, 1, 1/2, 1/3, 1/4, \dots\} \cup A \\ (0, 1) &= \{1/2, 1/3, 1/4, \dots\} \cup A\end{aligned}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned}A &= [0, 1] - \{0, 1, 1/2, 1/3, 1/4, \dots\} \\ &= (0, 1) - \{1/2, 1/3, 1/4, \dots\}.\end{aligned}$$

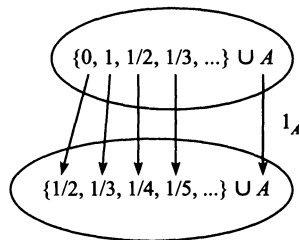
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Cardinality

Solution (continuation)

From the figure[†] we define the bijective function $f : [0, 1] \rightarrow (0, 1)$ by

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 1/2, & \text{if } x = 0; \\ 1/(n+1), & \text{if } x = 1/n \text{ where } n \in \mathbb{Z}^+; \\ x, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$



[†]Figure source: (Lipschutz [1964] 1998, Fig. 6.5).

Cardinality

Exercise

Let A and B be sets. Show $|A \times B| = |B \times A|$.

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

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Has all the infinite sets the same cardinality?

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A set that is not enumerable (not countable) is called **non-enumerable** (or **uncountable**).

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

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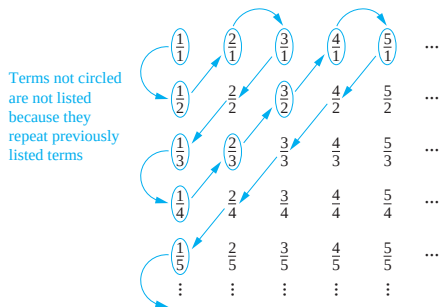
A set that is not enumerable (not countable) is called **non-enumerable** (or **uncountable**).

Example

Whiteboard.

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Example (the positive rational numbers are enumerable[†])



Remark: We do not define explicitly the function, but a **method (program)** for enumerating the set.

[†]Figure source: (Rosen [1988] 2012, § 2.5, Fig. 3).

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Theorem

The interval $(0, 1)$ is non-enumerable.

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Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Proof.

Let's suppose $(0, 1)$ is enumerable.

$$r_1 = 0.d_{11}d_{12}d_{13}d_{14}\dots$$

$$r_2 = 0.d_{21}d_{22}d_{23}d_{24}\dots$$

$$r_3 = 0.d_{31}d_{32}d_{33}d_{34}\dots$$

$$\vdots$$

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Proof.

Let's suppose $(0, 1)$ is enumerable.

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$$\vdots$$

Let $r = 0.d_1d_2d_3 \dots \in (0, 1)$, where

$$d_i = \begin{cases} 4, & \text{if } d_{ii} \neq 4; \\ 5, & \text{if } d_{ii} = 4. \end{cases}$$

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Proof.

Let's suppose $(0, 1)$ is enumerable.

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$$d_i = \begin{cases} 4, & \text{if } d_{ii} \neq 4; \\ 5, & \text{if } d_{ii} = 4. \end{cases}$$

The number r does not belong to the above enumeration. Therefore $(0, 1)$ is non-enumerable. 

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Theorem

Let A and B be sets such that $A \subseteq B$. If A is non-enumerable then B is non-enumerable.

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Theorem

The set of the real numbers is non-enumerable.

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

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The set of the real numbers is non-enumerable.

Proof.

The interval $(0, 1)$ is a non-enumerable subset of $\mathbb{R}$. Therefore (using a previous theorem), $\mathbb{R}$ is non-enumerable. ■

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Theorem

The set of the real numbers is non-enumerable.

Proof.

The interval $(0, 1)$ is a non-enumerable subset of $\mathbb{R}$. Therefore (using a previous theorem), $\mathbb{R}$ is non-enumerable. ■

Remark

Comment about the continuum hypothesis.

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Remark

The quadratic formulae are the solution to the quadratic equation

$$ax^2 + bx + c = 0.$$

Two quadratic formulae are

$$x = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}{2a}$$

and

$$x = \frac{-2c}{b \mp \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}. \tag{1}$$

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Example

Show that $|(-1, 1)| = |\mathbb{R}|$.

Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Example

Show that $|(-1, 1)| = |\mathbb{R}|$.

Solution

The function $f : (-1, 1) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ defined by

$$f(x) = \frac{x}{1 - x^2}$$

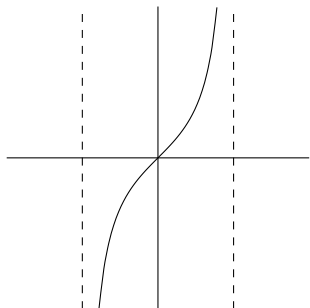
has as inverse the function $f^{-1} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow (-1, 1)$ given by (obtained using the quadratic formula (1))

$$f^{-1}(x) = \frac{2x}{1 + \sqrt{1 + 4x^2}}.$$

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Enumerable and Non-Enumerable Sets

Solution (continuation)



$$f(x) = \frac{x}{1-x^2}$$

Since the function f is a bijection then $|(-1, 1)| = |\mathbb{R}|$. Source: Munkres ([1974] 2000, Example § 18.5).

References

- Seymour Lipschutz [1964] (1998). Set Theory and Related Topics. 2nd ed. Schaum's Outline. McGraw-Hill (cit. on pp. 10–12).
- James R. Munkres [1974] (2000). Topology. 2nd ed. Prentice Hall (cit. on p. 30).
- Kenneth H. Rosen [1988] (2012). Discrete Mathematics and Its Applications. 7th ed. McGraw-Hill (cit. on p. 18).
- Bertrand Russell (1903). The Principles of Mathematics. Cambridge University Press (cit. on p. 9).